

PrEP JOB AID

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

- **How does PrEP work?**

PrEP (Pre-Exposure Prophylaxis) is a pill that prevents HIV from entering and replicating in cells. It's an Antiretroviral drug that's only for people who are HIV-Negative.

- **How long does it take to work?**

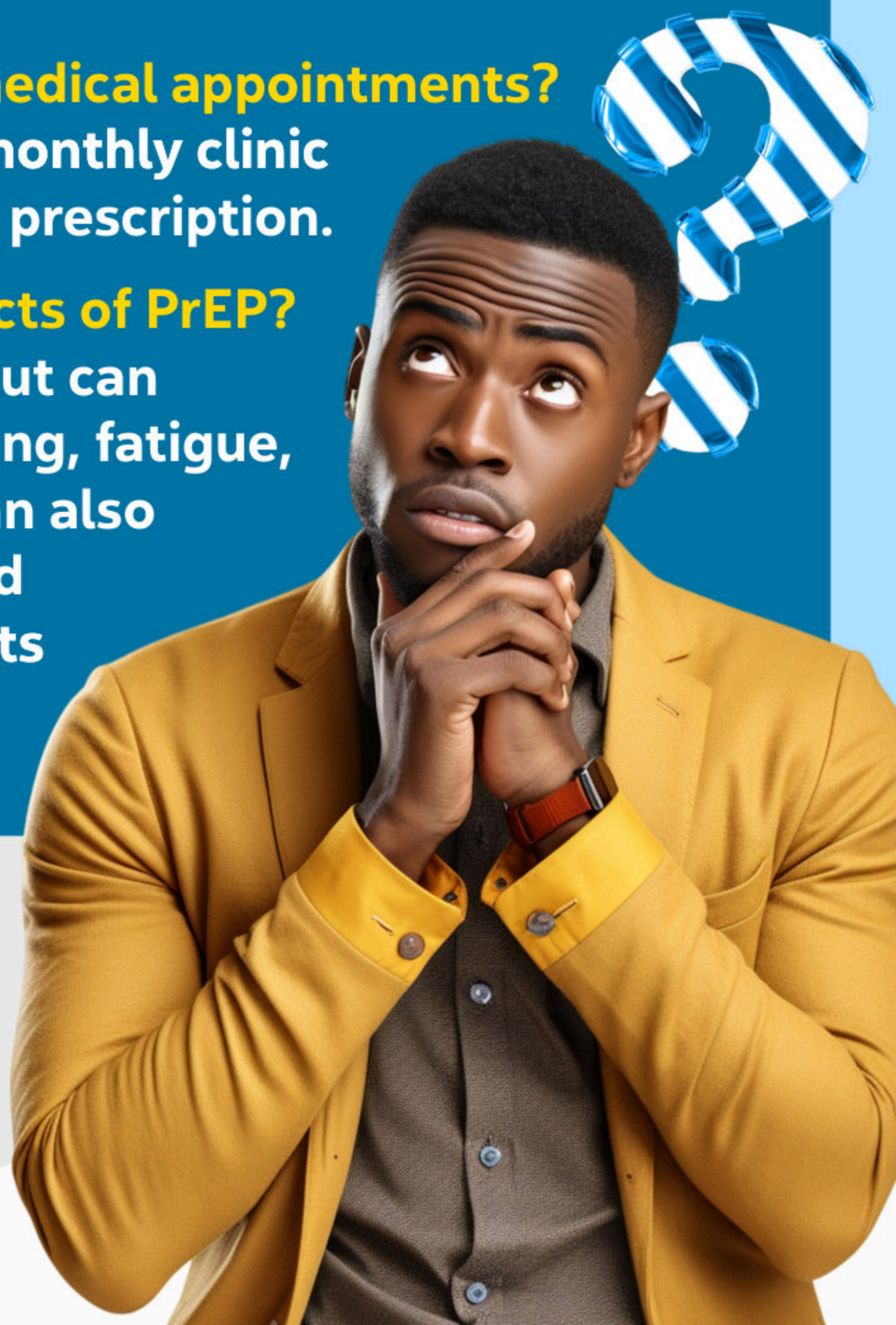
It takes up to 7 days to be fully protected after starting PrEP. For vaginal or anal sex, you need to take PrEP daily for 7 days. People assigned male at birth can take two tablets between 2–24 hours before, then one tablet 24 hours later, and another 24 hours after that.

- **How often do I need medical appointments?**

You'll need 6 regular monthly clinic visits to maintain your prescription.

- **What are the side effects of PrEP?**

Side effects are rare, but can include nausea, vomiting, fatigue, and headache. PrEP can also affect your kidneys and bones, but these effects are rare and stop once you stop taking PrEP.



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- **Can I stop taking PrEP?**

Yes, you can stop taking PrEP if you're no longer at risk of HIV. You should discuss this with your healthcare provider, and you may need to continue taking PrEP for four weeks after your last potential exposure to HIV.

- **Is PrEP safe to take while pregnant or breastfeeding?**

Yes, the pills are safe to take while pregnant or breastfeeding, but the injection is not recommended.

- **Is PrEP safe to take with alcohol?**

Yes, the pills are safe to take with alcohol, but drinking alcohol may affect the ability to adhere to medication.

- **Does PrEP interact with any prescription medication?**

PrEP is safe to take with prescription medication.

- **Does PrEP protect you from other sexually transmitted infections?**

No, it only protects against HIV infection. It does not protect against STIs or pregnancy.

- **Can I stop using condoms with PrEP?**

No, PrEP is an extra prevention option and should be used in combination with condoms.



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